

DANIELLE SCHMIDT-LARIOS

University of Wisconsin – Madison, Community & Environmental Sociology
1450 Linden Drive, Suite 308B, Madison, WI 53706
(847) 708-7772 | DSchmidt25@wisc.edu | www.DanielleSchmidtLarios.com

EDUCATION

- Exp. 2027 PhD, Sociology/Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison
Dissertation: Spatiotemporalities of Agricultural Land Loss
Committee: Katherine J. Curtis (chair) – Community & Environmental Sociology
Tessa Conroy – Ag & Applied Economics/Extension Specialist
Sarah Rios – Environmental Studies, Cal Poly Humboldt
Amanda McMillan Lequieu – Sociology, Drexel University
Prelim. Exams: Environmental Sociology (passed with distinction)
Sociology of Agrifood Systems
Minor: Geography
- 2023 MS, Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison
Thesis: Towards an Emplaced Vocabulary of Motive: Understanding the decision-making processes of agricultural landholders in the Upper Missouri River Breaks
- 2019 AB, Philosophy, Public Policy Studies (honors), The University of Chicago
Minor: Human Rights

PUBLICATIONS

- Boyce, McKenzie, Yang Cheng, Erin Gaede, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. 2027. “Measuring Rural Livability: Challenges, Choices, and Considerations.” In *Redefining Community Development Through Rural Livability*, edited by Tessa Conroy and Steven Deller. Community Development Series, Routledge. [In press]
- Schmidt-Larios, Danielle**. 2026. “Land through three approaches.” *Agriculture and Human Values*, 43(1). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10460-026-10853-1>.
- Schmidt, Danielle**, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2025. “Prosperity Across the United States: Revisiting the Isserman, Feser, and Warren Prosperity Index Using Sequence Analysis.” *International Regional Science Review* 49 (2): 147–78. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01600176251377424>.
- Schmidt, Danielle**. 2024. “Towards an Emplaced Vocabulary of Motive: Senses of Place and Land Sale Decision-Making in the Northern Great Plains.” *Rural Sociology*, 89(4), 975-995. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ruso.12574>.
- Schmidt, Danielle**. 2023. “Farming for sociologists: A new key text for rural sociologists.” *Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, and Community Development*, 12(4), 1–2. <https://doi.org/10.5304/jafscd.2023.124.004>
- Schmidt, Danielle** and Séamus A. Power. 2020. “Offline World: The Internet as Social Infrastructure among the Unconnected in Quasi-Rural Illinois.” *Integrative Psychological and Behavioral Science*, 55(2), 371-385. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12124-020-09574-9>.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

Under review

Boyce, Mckenzie, **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**, Erin Gaede, and Yang Cheng. “The Community Capitals for Quantitative Research: Data, Directions, and Debates,” *Journal of Rural Studies* [Revise and Resubmit]

Schmidt, Danielle and Katherine J. Curtis. “Leaving ‘Cowboy Ethnography’ in the Dust and Advancing the Practice of Collaborative Ethnography,” *Sociological Methods and Research* [First submit, April 2026]

Boyce, Mckenzie, Tessa Conroy, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. “A Fork in the Road: How Measurement Decisions Shape Narratives of Livability and Can Misrepresent Rural Places,” *Annals of Regional Science* [First submit, August 2026]

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Amanda McMillan Lequieu, and Katherine J. Curtis. 2027. “Home in a Changing Climate” [Invited by the International Sociological Association, submitted August 2026]

In preparation

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Sarah Rios. “Wildfires in the Workplace: A Survey of Latinx Farmworkers,” *Journal of Environmental Studies and Sciences*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Mckenzie Boyce, and Tessa Conroy. “Borrowing Natural Capital: Assessing the value of spatially shared natural amenities on local quality of life,” *Economic Geography*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. “Former Farms: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era,” *Land Use Policy*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Katherine J. Curtis. “To Lose One’s Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains,” *Rural Sociology*

Avila, Elisa, Katherine J. Curtis, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. “Place-based Framework for in-depth interviews across the Rural-Urban Continuum”

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Sarah Rios. “The manufactured precarity of farm work,” in *Handbook of Environmental Racism*, edited by Michael Mascarenhas, Julie Sze, Alex Huevo, Stephen Gasteyer, and Diana Ojeda. Anthem Press. [Abstract accepted/chapter invited]

Book Manuscript

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. *Reserved for whom? (Re)Making Home, Place, and Identity on Rural Landscapes*

OUTREACH & PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Mckenzie Boyce, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. (2026). *WIndicator: Sharing Livability: Assessing the Link Between Rural and Urban Prosperity* [Technical report]. University of Wisconsin–Madison Division of Extension. <https://doi.org/10.21231/mwem-5533>

Schmidt, Danielle, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller (2025). “Pathways to Prosperity: Moving Beyond Growth to Evaluate Change in Community Well-Being.” *Choices Magazine* 40 (2). <https://www.choicesmagazine.org/choices-magazine/submitted-articles/pathways-to-prosperity-moving-beyond-growth-to-evaluate-change-in-community-well-being> [peer reviewed]

- Schmidt, Danielle**, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. (2025). *WIndicator: Understanding Wisconsin prosperity in the national context* [Technical report]. University of Wisconsin–Madison Division of Extension. <https://doi.org/10.21231/BRBW-6V80>
- Curtis, Katherine J., **Danielle D. Schmidt**, and John C. Canfield. “Views on the Land.” *Phillips County News*, May 22, 2024. <https://www.phillipscountynews.com/story/2024/05/22/opinion/views-on-the-land/15471.html>
- Rios, Sarah and **Danielle Schmidt** (2023). “Survey Summary: A summary of farmworker responses to experiencing wildfires in the workplace.” Prepared for *Líderes Campesinas en California*. <https://liderescampesinas.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/F.I.R.E-Report-1030-.pdf>
- Schmidt, Danielle**. “Letter: Tyson the Bison and the Future of Farming.” *Daily Herald*, May 14, 2022. <https://www.dailyherald.com/discuss/20220514/letter-tyson-the-bison-and-the-future-of-farming>
- Curtis, Katherine J., John C. Canfield, and **Danielle D. Schmidt** (2021). “A Report on Population and Ag Production in Phillips County, Montana.” <https://apl.wisc.edu/shared/conservation-agriculture-rural/phillips-county>

AWARDS & HONORS

- | | |
|-----------|---|
| May 2026 | John Harrison Kolb Memorial Scholarship Award for <i>exceptional intellectual contributions, academic achievements, and professional involvement</i> , Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison |
| Apr. 2026 | Calvin L. Beale Graduate Award for <i>perpetuating the belief that understanding the people behind the statistics is the very essence of sociological research</i> , Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison |
| Mar. 2025 | Ronald Wimberley Graduate Student Paper Competition for <i>making a strong contribution to our understanding of rural community life and health</i> , Community, Health, and Family Research Interest Group, Rural Sociological Society |
| Nov. 2023 | Honored Instructor for <i>positive impact on students</i> , University Housing (student nominated), UW-Madison |
| Jun. 2019 | Richard P. Taub Prize for <i>best thesis</i> , Dept. of Public Policy, The University of Chicago |
| Nov. 2018 | Abraham Lincoln Civic Engagement Award for <i>leadership and service in the pursuit of the betterment of humanity</i> , UChicago Recipient, The Lincoln Academy of Illinois |

COMPETITIVE RESEARCH FUNDING

- | | |
|-----------|---|
| May 2026 | Grad Student “Small Grant” Competition, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison, \$390 |
| May 2025 | Summer Mini-Grant, Center for Integrated Agricultural Systems (CIAS), \$2,991.80 |
| Mar. 2025 | Dissertation Research Award, Rural Sociological Society, \$2,800 |
| May 2024 | Evelyn T. Crowe Scholarship – Pre-Dissertation Research, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison, \$2,585 |
| May 2022 | Evelyn T. Crowe Scholarship – Master’s Thesis Research, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison, \$5,000 |
| Mar. 2022 | Grad Student “Small Grant” Competition, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison, \$165 |

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Appointments

- 2024 - Graduate Research Assistant, UW-Madison Agriculture & Applied Economics
Wisconsin Rural Partnership Initiative: [The Rural Livability Project](#)
Professor Tessa Conroy, Primary Investigator
- 2021-23 Graduate Research Assistant, UW-Madison Community & Environmental Sociology
Crisis and Adaptation: How Wildfires Change the Agricultural Workplace
Professor Sarah M. Rios, Primary Investigator
- 2020-21 State Research Assistantship, UW-Madison Community & Environmental Sociology
[Conflict at the Intersection of Production and Conservation](#)
Professor Katherine J. Curtis, Supervisor

Contracts

- Spring 2026 GIS data visualization, Economic impact of hospitals on the Wisconsin economy
Professor Steven Deller (Emeritus, UW-Madison)
- Spring 2025 Qualitative data collection, Rural Informal Work in economically, socially, culturally, and technologically changing contexts
Professor Emily Wornell (Ball State), Primary Investigator; Professors Amanda McMillan Lequieu (Drexel) and Jean Hardy (Michigan State), Supervisors

TEACHING POSITIONS

Appointments

- Fall 2023 TA, SOC 125: *American Society: How It Really Works*, UW-Madison Dept of Sociology
37 students; 4.86/5 mean overall student evaluation (department mean 4.45/5)
- Spring 2023 TA, ILS 200: *Critical Thinking & Expression*, UW-Madison Integrated Liberal Studies
34 students; mode score 5/5 across all student evaluation questions

Service & Mentorship

- 2026 - Supervisor, Undergraduate Research Assistant for the Rural Livability Project
- 2025-26 Capstone Project "Expert," Dept. of Agriculture and Applied Economics, UW-Madison
- 2024-25 ESL Instructor (Adult Education), Madison International Partners
- 2024-26 Research Mentor, AP Capstone Research, Mentor Matching Engine

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

- Sep. 2026 "Deep Mapping Change in Human-Land Relations on the Northern Great Plains,"
Symposium of the National Endowment for the Humanities (NEH) Community Deep
Mapping Institute (CDMI), held in Sumter, South Carolina
- Apr. 2026 "Reserved: The transition of production agricultural land to conservation reserves across
two cases," Michigan Technological University Dept. of Social Sciences, held in
Houghton, MI
- Nov. 2025 "Reserved for whom?" *Conservation Biology*, Williams College [Guest lecture]

- Oct. 2025 “Reserved for whom?” *Environment, Natural Resources, and Society*, UW-Madison [Guest lecture]
- Oct. 2025 “Cowboy Ethnography: Challenges of and strategies for collaborative spatial data collection and community engaged methods in the twenty-first century,” American Philosophical Society International Symposium on the Future of Fieldwork, held in Philadelphia, PA (*view recording [here](#)*)
- Jun. 2025 “What Makes a Place ‘Livable’?” Connecting Entrepreneurial Communities, held in Wisconsin Rapids, WI (*view presentation slides [here](#)*)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Nov. 2026 “Constructing the Myth of the Wilderness: Examining the sociopolitical process of creating conservation reserves,” Social Science History Association; Atlanta, GA
- Aug. 2026 “Borrowing Natural Capital: Assessing the value of spatially shared natural amenities on local livability,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Raleigh, NC
- Aug. 2026 “Negotiating Salvation: Conflict in Conservation,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Raleigh, NC
- Nov. 2025 “Former Farms, Future Farming: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era using remote sensing and administrative data,” North American Regional Science Council Annual Meeting; Denver, CO
- Jul. 2025 “Former Farms, Future Farming: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era using remote sensing and administrative data,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Salt Lake City, UT
- Jul. 2025 “The Spatial Diffusion of Rural Livability Across the Urban-Rural Interface,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Salt Lake City, UT
- Jul. 2025 “To Lose One’s Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains,” International Sociological Association; Rabat, Morocco
- Mar. 2025 “The Spatial Diffusion of Rural Livability Across the Urban-Rural Interface,” American Association of Geographers; Detroit, MI
- Jul. 2024 “To Lose One’s Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Madison, WI
- Nov. 2023 “Wildfires in the Workplace: Understanding the manufactured precarity of farm work in a changing climate,” Social Science History Association Annual Conference; Washington, D.C.
- Apr. 2023 “Pricing the Prairie: Large-Scale Conservation and Early-Stage Rural Gentrification in a Western Agricultural Community,” Population Assoc. of America; New Orleans, LA
- Nov. 2022 “A Done Deed: The Socially Contentious Decision to Sell Production Land,” Social Science History Association Annual Conference; Chicago, IL
- Jul. 2021 “‘Save the Cowboy’: Large-Scale Conservation and Early-Stage Rural Gentrification in a Western Agricultural Community,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Virtual

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS & AFFILIATIONS

Rural Sociological Society; Social Science History Association; American Association of Geographers

SERVICE TO DEPARTMENT & PROFESSION

Jan. 2026 Member, Awards and Endowment Committee, Rural Sociological Society
 2023-25 Co-Chair, Rural, Ag, and Environmental Network, Social Science History Association
 2023 Organizing Committee, UW Agroecology Symposium: “Relationships for Change”
 2022 Graduate Student Rep., Ethics Committee, Rural Sociological Society
 2020-22 Member, Culture & Climate Committee, UW-Madison Sociology Grad Student Assoc.

REFeree EXPERIENCE

Journals: *Agriculture and Human Values*; *International Journal of Sociology of Agriculture and Food*;
Review of Regional Studies

Books: *Redefining Community Development Through Rural Livability*

Grants: Rural Sociological Society; North Central Sustainable Agriculture and Research Education

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software: R, ArcGIS (Pro, StoryMaps), Qualtrics, NVivo
 Languages: English (native), Spanish (limited working proficiency)
 Certifications: (Farmer-oriented) Mental Health First Aid, UW-Madison Research Mentor Badge

REFERENCES

Katherine J. Curtis

Buttel-Sewell Professor
 Dept of Community & Environmental Sociology
 Director, Center for Demography & Ecology
 University of Wisconsin-Madison
 (608) 890-1900
kcurtis@ssc.wisc.edu

Tessa Conroy

Associate Professor
 Extension Economic Development Specialist
 Dept of Agricultural and Applied Economics
 University of Wisconsin-Madison
 (608) 265-4327
tessa.conroy@wisc.edu

Steven Deller

Professor Emeritus
 Vilas Distinguished Achievement Professor
 Extension Economic Development Specialist
 Dept of Agricultural and Applied Economics
 University of Wisconsin-Madison
 (608) 263-6251
scdeller@wisc.edu

Amanda McMillan Lequieu

Assistant Professor
 Department of Sociology
 Drexel University
amanda.mcmillanlequieu@drexel.edu

Sarah Rios

Assistant Professor
 Department of Environmental Studies
 California Polytechnic University, Humboldt
 (707) 826-4975
smr247@humboldt.edu